

ten out as dotted octets with the decimal values of the four bytes separated by dots. An example is 128.128.4.129.

IPX (Internet Packet Exchange)

A Novell NetWare communications protocol used to route messages from one node to another. IPX is not able to always deliver a complete message, because an IPX packet can sometimes get lost when a network boundary is being crossed.

ISP (Internet Service Provider)

An institution that provides a user—a home user, for example—access to the Internet, usually for a fee.

LAN (Local Area Network)

A communications network that links PCs and other devices in a single office, across offices, in homes, or in a small campus. In client/server LANs, user PCs (the clients) access shared files and sometimes applications stores on a PC that acts as the server. In peer-to-peer networks, any connected PC can serve as a client or a server.

Parity

The data that is used to detect or correct single-bit failures. A parity bit, if used, comes attached with the data transmitted. Parity is normally associated with hard drives or system memory.

PPP (Point-to-Point Protocol)

A protocol that allows a user to connect to the internet using a standard telephone line and modem. PPP features error-detection and data protection unlike older systems such as SLIP.

RAID (Redundant Array of Independent Disks)

A group of two or more hard drives, which together provide increased performance with increased probabilities of error recovery and fault tolerance. Can be implemented in the operating system, by software with standard disk controllers, or designed in the disk controller itself.